

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Preaching peaceful protest

ICE DETENTIONS

Advocates warn of chilling effect on victims after 2 arrested at courthouse

By Madeline Buckley and William Tong
Chicago Tribune

Immigration agents this week arrested at least two people in the vicinity of Cook County’s domestic violence-focused courthouse, sparking fears that the enforcement action would have a chilling effect on people seeking orders of protection and other forms of help at the courthouse.

The presence at the facility at 555 W. Harrison St. came as local residents and politicians are bracing for a surge of Immigration and Customs Enforcement raids in Chicago while officials forecast a possible monthlong operation.

“It’s an affront to all the work this country has done over the last 40 years to ensure that victims of domestic violence and sexual assault have access to justice,” said Amanda Pyron, president and CEO of The Network: Advocating Against Domestic Violence.

Turn to Detentions, Page 4



Marking the start of the school year, Gov. JB Pritzker, right, greets teachers and staff members at Prairie Oak Elementary School in Berwyn on Thursday. Pritzker was at the school to talk about the effects of pending federal actions on school communities. **ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE**

IN CHICAGOLAND: Chicago Public Schools has sent multiple emails to assure families it is prepared for a potential National Guard presence in the city.

■ El Grito Chicago postponed as city braces for increased immigration enforcement.

MILITARY DEPLOYMENT

Immigration enforcement surge expected; Trump wavers on sending Guard

By Dan Petrella, Jason Meisner, Alice Yin and A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

Preparing for an expected surge of federal immigration enforcement that could begin any day, Gov. JB Pritzker and other leaders on Thursday underscored their calls for peaceful protests amid President Donald Trump’s wavering threats to send military personnel to Chicago under the guise of combating violent crime.

Late Thursday, federal authorities were clearly moving forward with preparations. Workers in the evening began installing security fencing around the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse, which is across the street from Chicago’s Federal Plaza, the site of many protests. One U.S. Homeland Security vehicle was parked at the corner of Jackson Boulevard and Dearborn Street.

The moves came one day after Trump

Turn to Enforcement, Page 4



‘He still meant something to all of us’

Shooting death of homeless man known as ‘Pepe’ shakes Pilsen



Above: A memorial stands in Pilsen for a local homeless man, Pedro “Pepe” Toledo Catalan, who died in a shooting Sunday morning near South Wolcott Avenue and 17th Street in Chicago. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Top: Mercedes Gonzalez, center, leads mourners in prayer on Wednesday for Catalan at the site where he was fatally wounded. Catalan could be seen walking in the neighborhood over the past 20 years, according to residents. Gonzalez was related to Catalan by marriage. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

By Tess Kenny and Caroline Kubzansky
Chicago Tribune

For the second night in a row, Mercedes Gonzalez stood on a Near Southwest Side street corner clutching a set of red rosary beads and repeated a Hail Mary.

“Santa María, Madre de Dios, ruega por nosotros, pecadores, ahora y en la hora de nuestra muerte. Amen.”

Around her, a crowd of some 30 people stood in silence. Some bowed their heads. Others closed their eyes. At their feet was an array of candles and flowers. And behind the makeshift memorial, balloons wrapped around a light pole that carried the words, in white lettering, “R.I.P Pepe.”

Pedro Toledo Catalan, known by that nickname, was shot and killed early Sunday in Pilsen in the 1900 block of West 17th Street, according to Chicago police and the Cook County medical examiner’s office. He was believed to be homeless, with his official home address unknown, the office said.

“(But) even though he was homeless, he was still part of our community,” lifelong Pilsen resident Erica Hernandez, 40, said. “He still meant something to all

Turn to Catalan, Page 2

Northwestern president resigns amid funding freeze

Schill and the school subject to conservative criticism

By Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

Northwestern University President Michael Schill announced Thursday that he will resign, concluding a three-year tenure marked by five months of an unprecedented \$790 million federal funding freeze.

The school never received formal notification of the abrupt pause, which came amid several federal investigations into allegations of antisemitism. The move rattled students and faculty, and left Schill at the helm of a bitter fight between the Trump administration and elite universities across the U.S.

Northwestern, along with Schill, had already been subject to an onslaught of conservative criticism. Last spring, he was grilled for hours before a Republican-led congressional committee on the campus environment for Jewish students.

But those pressures have only mounted under President Donald Trump — who has increasingly placed higher education under fire for antisemitism and diversity, equity and inclusion practices.

In a message to the Northwestern community Thursday morning, Schill acknowledged the “difficult problems” at the federal level. He said he would remain in the role until an interim president is named.

“From the very beginning of my tenure, Northwestern faced serious and often painful challenges,” Schill said. “In the face of those challenges and the hard, but necessary choices that were before us, I was always guided by enduring values of our University: protecting students, fostering academic excellence, and defending faculty, academic freedom, due process and the integrity of the institution.”

Schill, 66, will continue to collaborate with the university’s board of trustees on efforts to restore funding, the university said. Once he steps down, he will take a sabbatical before returning as a faculty member at the Pritzker School of Law.

In the months since the funding pause, Schill and other school officials have overseen a string of belt-tightening measures. That included mass layoffs in



Turn to Schill, Page 5

Kennedy takes heat from all sides

The health secretary faced pointed bipartisan questioning at a rancorous Senate hearing on his staff and vaccine policy shifts. **Nation & World**

The Bears’ one-two punches

How the Bears divvy up workload for tight ends Colston Loveland and Cole Kmet will be an intriguing subplot for Week 1 against the Vikings. **Chicago Sports**

Italian fashion master dies

Giorgio Armani, who turned the concept of understated elegance into a multibillion-dollar fashion empire, has died. He was 91. **Obituaries, Page 9**

